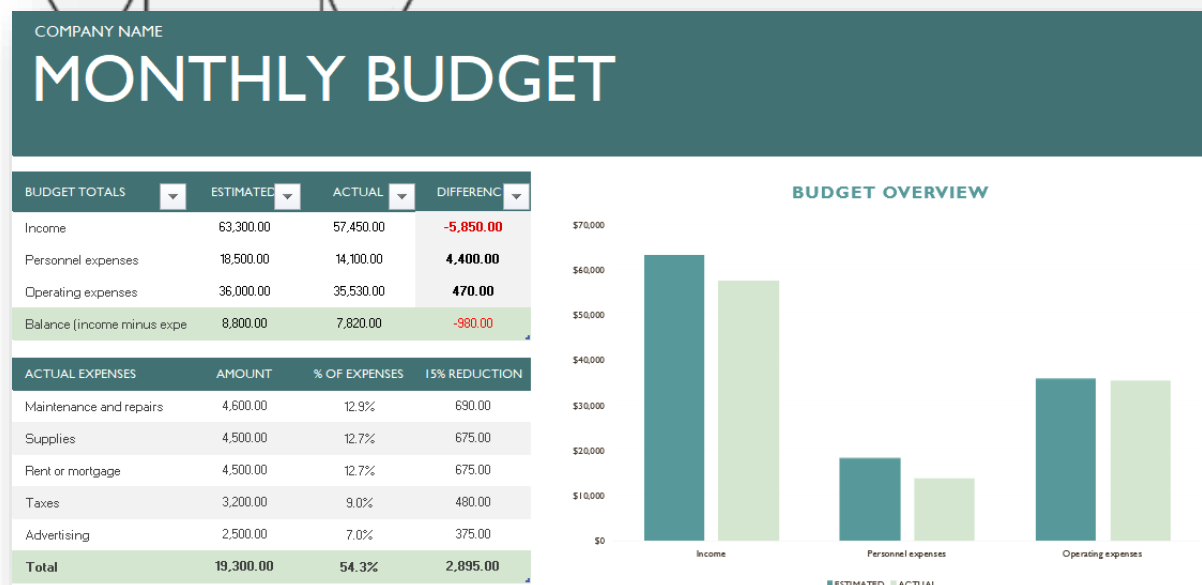


Microsoft Excel in a Glance



EXCEL
IN
EXCEL



STEP
B
Y
STEP
WITH VISUAL EXAMPLES



Created with Love ♥

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Contents

About this Book	5
How to Use This Book.....	5
CHAPTER 1	6
OPEN A NEW WORKBOOK.....	6
OVERVIEW OF THE EXCEL SCREEN	6
WRITING TEXT INSIDE A CELL	7
ENTER DATE & TIME.....	7
HIGHLIGHT A SPECIFIC AREA OR THE ENTIRE SHEET	7
SAVE A WORKBOOK	8
MODIFY, MOVE AND COPY CELL	8
FILL HANDLE.....	9
FONT, ALIGNMENT AND FORMAT PAINTER	9
CHAPTER 2	10
ADD A NEW WORKSHEET	10
HIDE, UNHIDE A WORKSHEET	10
HIDE, UNHIDE A WORKBOOK	11
RENAME, MOVE, COPY OR DELETE A SHEET	11
SELECT ALL SHEETS.....	12
MODIFY A CELL IN ALL SHEETS AT THE SAME TIME.....	13
CHAPTER 3	14
PASTE SPECIAL	14
ZOOM IN / ZOOM OUT	14
INSERT OR DELETE ROWS, COLUMNS, OR CELLS	15
RESIZE ROWS/COLUMNS TO FIT CONTENTS.....	15
MERGE CELLS.....	16
CHAPTER 4	17
CREATE TABLES	17
APPLYING FILTER	17
FREEZE PANES.....	18
HIDING GRIDLINES	18
NAME A SPECIFIC AREA OF CELLS AND CALL IT IN EXCEL	18
INSERT A COMMENT IN A CELL.....	18
ADDING A SMALL REMINDER, USING A NOTE	19
FIND AND REPLACE	19



CHAPTER 5 20

CHECK SPELLING 20

FORMAT CELLS & SHEET PROTECTION 20

CONDITIONAL FORMATTING 22

SORTING DATA..... 22

CHAPTER 6 24

CHARTS 24

VALIDATION 25

HYPERLINK 25

PAGE SETUP 26

PRINT..... 27

CHAPTER 7 28

Functions..... 28

MACRO 30

PIVOT TABLE 31

Welcome to **Microsoft Excel at a Glance**, your quick guide to mastering this essential workplace tool. Whether you're a beginner opening Excel for the first time or someone looking to strengthen your existing skills, this book is designed to make learning simple, visual, and effective.

About this Book

This eBook is designed to help beginners and students build a solid foundation in Microsoft Excel, one of the most essential tools used across nearly every field, from business and banking to education and administration. Whether you're a student preparing for future employment or a professional looking to enhance your productivity, this guide will help you gain the confidence and skills needed to use Excel effectively.

This is a **step-by-step guide**, short, clear, and direct. Each topic is broken down into **easy-to-follow steps**, so you can **learn and apply Excel quickly** without getting lost in unnecessary details.

How to Use This Book

Each section in this eBook introduces a specific Excel tool or feature. First, **read the explanation** and follow the steps carefully to understand how to **apply the tool** in your own worksheet. Then, **watch the short video** provided for a quick visual demonstration; this will help you see exactly how the **tool works** in action. Hold **Ctrl** key from the keyboard and click the YouTube icon  to open the video.

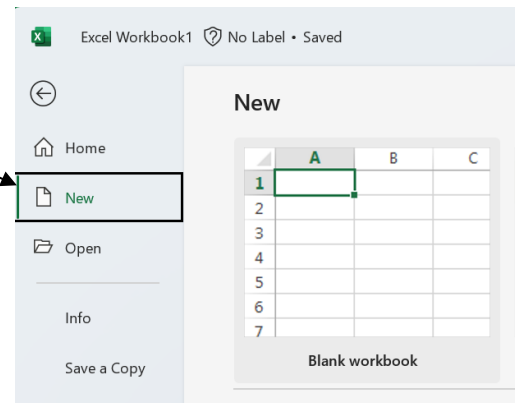
It's recommended to **practice** after each **topic** by **recreating the examples** on your computer. This hands-on approach will strengthen your understanding and help you **use Excel confidently** in real situations.

CHAPTER 1

OPEN A NEW WORKBOOK

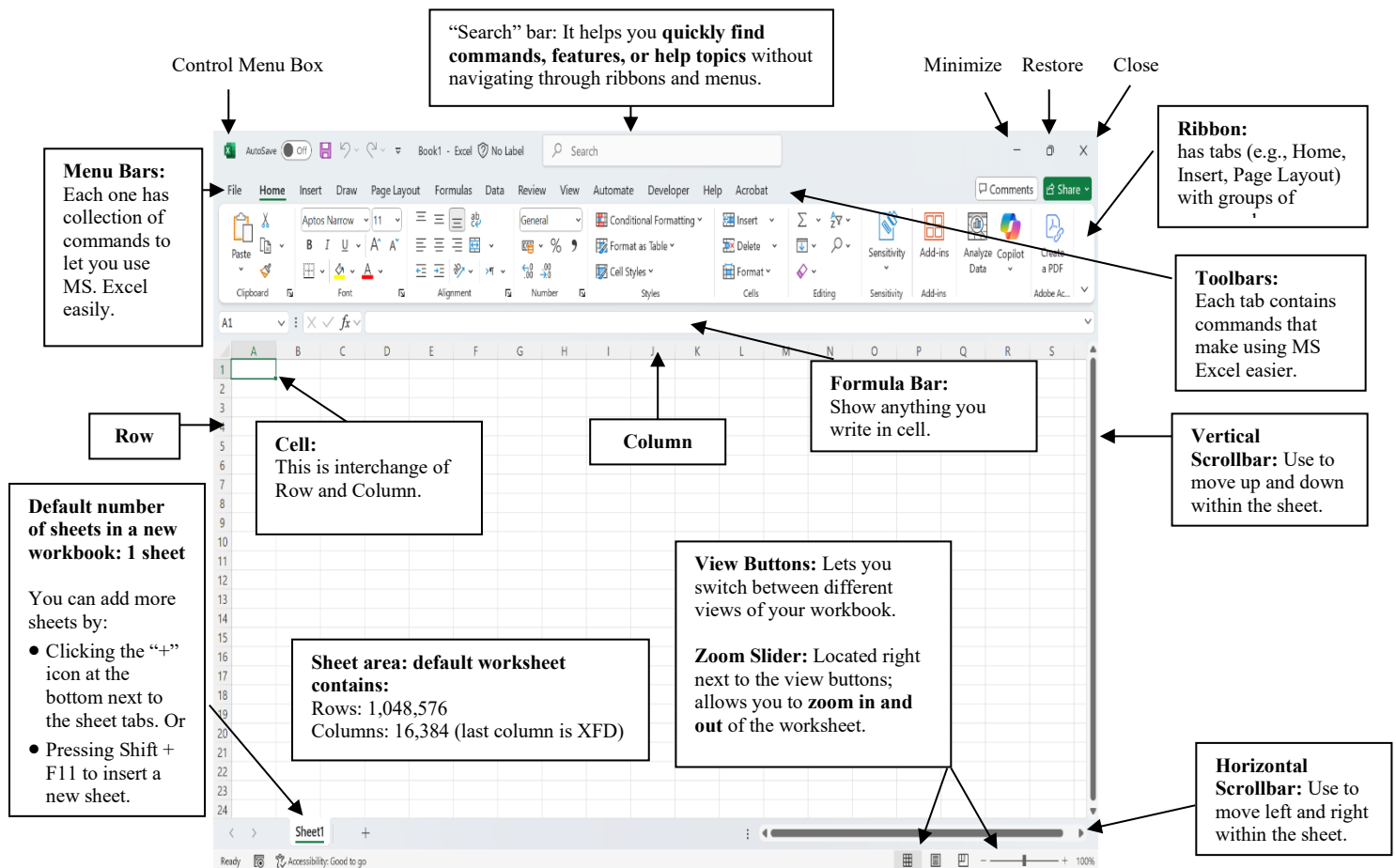
You can open a new workbook in Excel by two ways:

1. Go to **File** → **New** → **Blank Workbook**, then click to open a new workbook.
2. **Using Keyboard Shortcut:**
Press **Ctrl + N** to instantly open a new workbook.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

OVERVIEW OF THE EXCEL SCREEN



WRITING TEXT INSIDE A CELL

In Excel, **writing text inside a cell** is simple. Here's how you do it:

1. **Select the cell** where you want to enter text.
2. **Type your text** directly.
3. **Press Enter** to move to the cell below, or **Tab** to move to the next cell on the right.



Tips:

- To **start a new line within the same cell**, press **Alt + Enter** (Windows) or **Option + Command + Enter** (Mac).
- If the text is too long, you can **wrap text** by selecting the cell → **Home** → **Wrap Text**.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

ENTER DATE & TIME

In Excel, you can **enter date and time** in a cell in a few simple ways:

1. Enter Current Date

- Select a cell and press **Ctrl + ;** (semicolon).
- Excel will insert today's date.

2. Enter Current Time

- Select a cell and press **Ctrl + Shift + ;**
- Excel will insert current time.

3. Enter Both Date & Time

- Press **Ctrl + ;**, then type a space, then press **Ctrl + Shift + ;**
- This will insert both date and time in the same cell.

4. Manual Entry

- You can type date like 20/10/2025 or 20-Oct-2025.
- You can type time like 12:30 PM or 14:30.

5. Formatting

- Select the cell → **Right-click** → **Format Cells** → **Number** → **Date** or **Time** to choose the display style you want.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

HIGHLIGHT A SPECIFIC AREA OR THE ENTIRE SHEET

	A	B	C
1			
2	1. Highlight a Specific Area		
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Click and drag your mouse over the cells you want to highlight



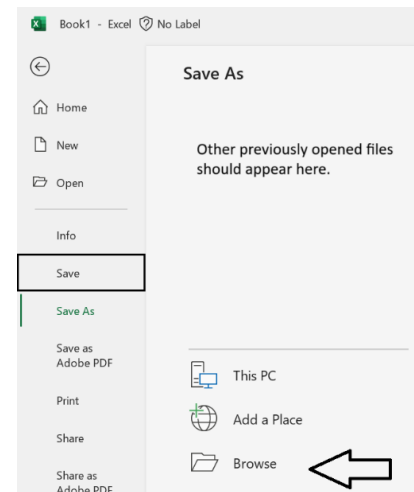
See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

SAVE A WORKBOOK

In Excel, **saving a workbook** can be done in a few ways:

1. Save for the First Time (or Save As)

1. Click **File** → **Save or Save As**.
2. Click **Browse**, choose the **location** where you want to save (e.g., This PC, OneDrive, or a folder).
3. Enter a **file name**.
4. Choose the **file type** (usually .xlsx for Excel Workbook).
5. Click **Save**.

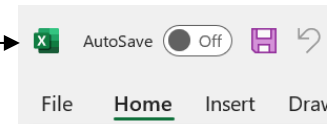


2. Save Updates to an Existing Workbook

- Click **File** → **Save**, or simply press **Ctrl + S**.

💡 Tips

- Use **Save As** if you want to **create a copy** with a different name or location.
- Excel automatically saves files with **.xlsx** extension unless you choose a different format.
- Enable **AutoSave** (top-left corner in Excel 365) to save changes automatically.

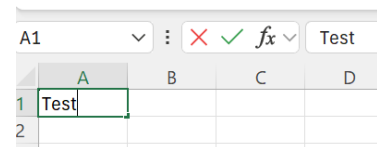


MODIFY, MOVE AND COPY CELL

In Excel, you can modify, move, and copy cells in the following ways:

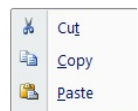
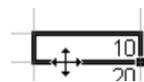
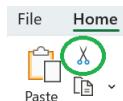
1. Modify a Cell

- **Directly:** Select the cell and start typing → press **Enter** to save changes.
- **Edit in place:** Double-click the cell or press **F2**, make changes, then press **Enter**.



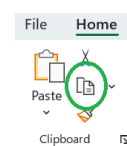
2. Move a Cell

- Select the cell or range → hover over the **border** until the cursor becomes a four-sided arrow → **drag** to the new location.
- Or, select the cell → **Cut (Ctrl + X)** → select destination → **Paste (Ctrl + V)**.
- Or, right-click on the cell or range of cells → select **Cut** → choose the destination → right-click → select **Paste**.
- Or, select **Cut** from the **Home** toolbar



3. Copy a Cell

- Select the cell → **Copy (Ctrl + C)** → select destination → **Paste (Ctrl + V)**.
- Or, **drag the fill handle** (small square at bottom-right corner) to copy to adjacent cells.
- Or, right-click on the cell or range of cells → select **Copy** → choose the destination → right-click → select **Paste**.
- Or, select **Copy** from the **Home** toolbar



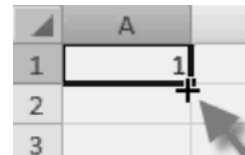
💡 Tips:

- To **move or copy multiple cells**, select a range instead of a single cell.
- Use **Paste Special** for advanced options like copying only values, formulas, or formatting.

▶ **See how it works:** Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

FILL HANDLE

The **fill handle** in Excel is a tool that **helps you quickly copy or fill data** in cells.



Fill Handle

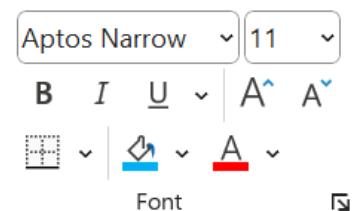
1. **Select the cell** you want to copy or extend.
2. **Move your cursor** to the bottom-right corner of the cell until it changes into a **small black plus sign (+)**. This is the **fill handle**.
3. **Click and drag** the fill handle over the cells where you want to copy or extend the content.
4. **Release the mouse button**. The cells will now be filled with the copied content or series.

▶ **See how it works:** Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

FONT, ALIGNMENT AND FORMAT PAINTER

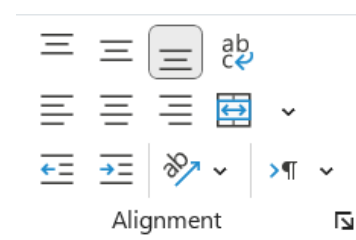
1. Font Settings

- Go to the **Home tab** → **Font group**.
- You can adjust:
 1. **Font Type** – e.g., Arial, Calibri, Times New Roman.
 2. **Font Size** – make text bigger or smaller.
 3. **Font Style** – Bold, Italic, Underline.
 4. **Font Color** – change text color.
 5. **Fill Color** – change cell background color.
 6. **Borders** – add cell borders for clarity.



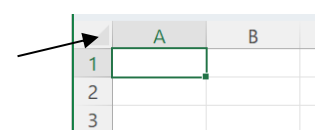
2. Alignment Settings

- Go to the **Home tab** → **Alignment group**.
- You can adjust:
 1. **Horizontal Alignment** – Left, Center, Right.
 2. **Vertical Alignment** – Top, Middle, Bottom.
 3. **Wrap Text** – make long text appear on multiple lines inside the cell.
 4. **Merge & Center** – combine multiple cells and center the text.
 5. **Orientation** – rotate text inside the cell.



3. **Format Painter:** it allows you to **copy formatting from one cell and apply it to other cells** without manually changing font, color, borders, or alignment.

2. **Click the Select All button**, the small triangle or box at the **top-left corner** of the sheet (between the row numbers and column letters).



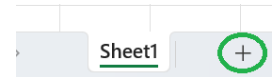
▶ **See how it works:** Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

CHAPTER 2

ADD A NEW WORKSHEET

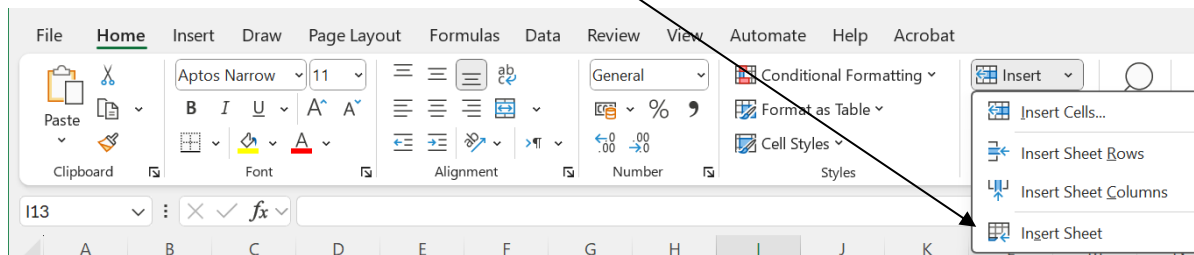
1. Using the Plus (+) Icon

- Click the **+** icon next to the existing sheet tabs at the bottom of the Excel window.
→ A new worksheet (e.g., *Sheet2*, *Sheet3*) will be added instantly.



2. Using the Ribbon

- Go to **Home** → **Insert** → **Insert Sheet**.



3. Using Keyboard Shortcut

- Press **Shift + F11** to quickly insert a new worksheet.

Tip:

- On some laptops, you might need to press **Fn + Shift + F11** (because the F-keys are shared with other functions).



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

HIDE, UNHIDE A WORKSHEET



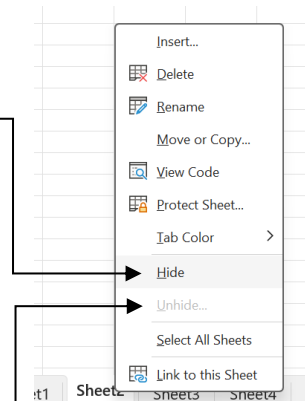
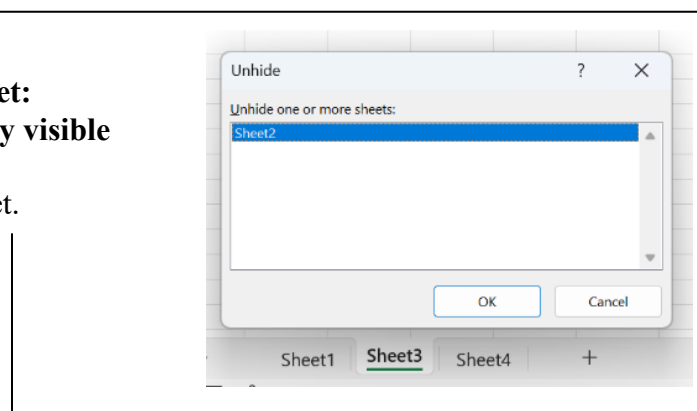
To Hide a Sheet:

- Right-click the **sheet tab** you want to hide (bottom of the screen).
- Click **Hide**.



To Unhide a Sheet:

- Right-click **any visible sheet tab**.
- Select the sheet.
- Click **Unhide**.

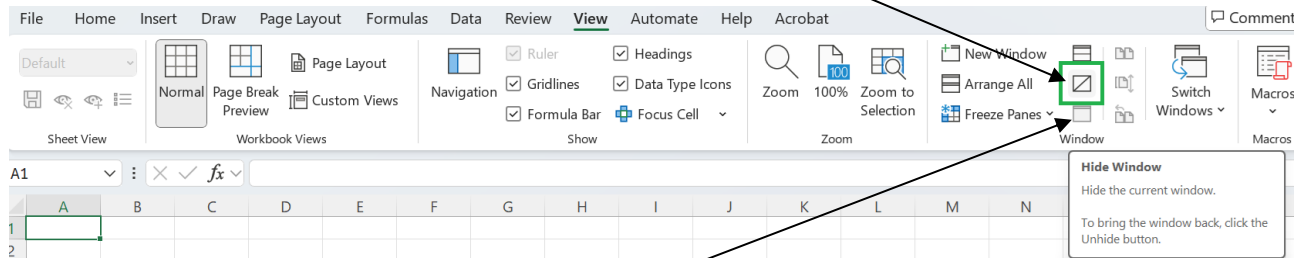


See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

HIDE, UNHIDE A WORKBOOK

1. Using the Ribbon Menu

- Go to the **View** tab.
- In the **Window** group, click **Hide**.
→ The active workbook will be hidden from view.



4. To Unhide the Workbook

- Go to **View** → **Unhide**.
- Select the workbook you want to display again.
- Click **OK**.



Tip:

- Hiding a workbook only hides its window, it doesn't close or delete it.
- When you save your file while it's hidden, it will open hidden next time until you unhide it manually.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

RENAME, MOVE, COPY OR DELETE A SHEET

1 Rename a Sheet

There are a few ways:

Method 1: Double-click

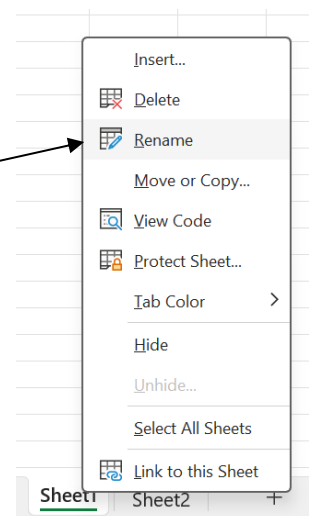
- Go to the sheet tab at the bottom (e.g., "Sheet1").
- Double-click the tab name.
- Type the new name and press **Enter**.

Method 2: Right-click

- Right-click the sheet tab.
- Select **Rename**.
- Type the new name and press **Enter**.

Method 3: Using Ribbon

- Go to **Home** → **Format** → **Rename Sheet**.
- Type the new name.



Sheet names cannot exceed 31 characters or contain: \ / ? * [].

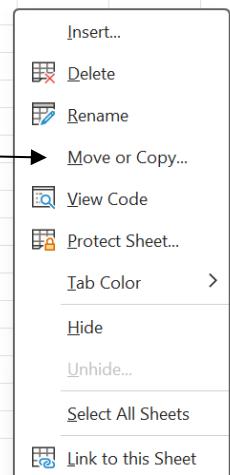
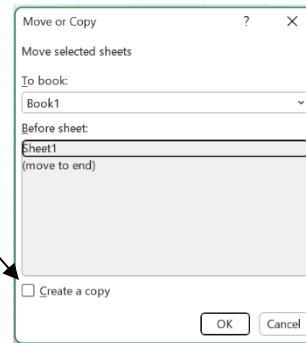
2 Move or Copy a Sheet

Method 1: Drag & Drop (Move)

1. Click the sheet tab you want to move.
2. Drag it left or right to the desired position.

Method 2: Right-click → Move or Copy

1. Right-click the sheet tab.
2. Select **Move or Copy...**
3. In the dialog box:
 - **To book:** Choose the current workbook or (New Book).
 - **Before sheet:** Choose where to place it.
 - **Create a copy:** Check this box if you want a copy instead of moving it.
4. Click **OK**.



Method 3: Using Ribbon

1. Go to **Home** → **Format** → **Move or Copy Sheet**.
2. Follow the same steps as above.

3 Delete a Sheet

1. **Right-click** the sheet tab you want to delete (at the bottom of the screen).
2. Click **Delete**.
3. A warning may appear: **“Data in the sheet will be permanently deleted.”**
4. Click **Delete** (or **OK**) to confirm.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

SELECT ALL SHEETS

Steps to Select All Sheets:

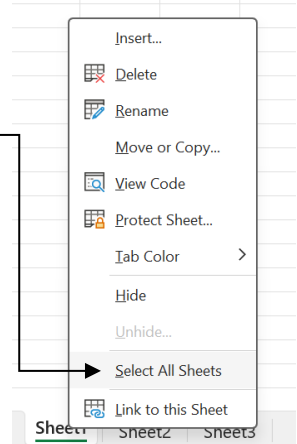
1. **Right-click** on any sheet tab at the bottom of Excel.
2. Click **Select All Sheets** from the menu.

◆ Shortcut Method:

- Click on the **first sheet tab**, then **hold Shift** and click on the **last sheet tab**, this selects all sheets between them. You can also select different random sheets by holding the **Ctrl** key and then clicking on the sheets.

◆ To Unselect Sheets:

- **Right-click** any sheet tab and choose **Ungroup Sheets**, or simply click on any sheet tab that is **not grouped**.



⚠ Note:

Be careful, any edits you make while all sheets are selected will affect **every sheet** in the workbook.

MODIFY A CELL IN ALL SHEETS AT THE SAME TIME

1. **Select all sheets**
2. **Select the cell** you want to change (e.g., **A1**).
3. **Type your new data or formula**, then press **Enter**.
 - The change will appear in the same cell in **every selected sheet**.
4. **Ungroup sheets**
 - Right-click any sheet tab → click **Ungroup Sheets**
(or click any sheet tab not in the group)

Important:

While sheets are grouped, **any change** (typing, deleting, formatting, etc.) affects **all grouped sheets**, so make sure to ungroup after editing.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

CHAPTER

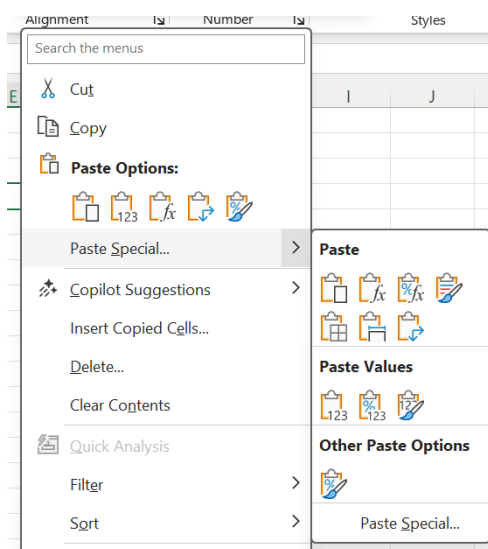
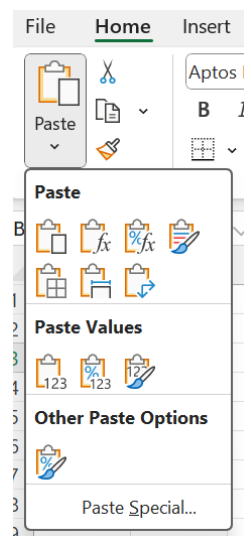
3

PASTE SPECIAL

✿ **Paste Special** is a feature in Excel that allows you to **control exactly what you paste** from copied data, such as values, formulas, formats, comments, or validation rules, instead of pasting everything.

◆ How to Use Paste Special:

1. **Copy** the cell or range you want.
(Right-click → **Copy** or press **Ctrl + C**)
2. **Select** the destination cell or range.
3. On the **Home** tab, click the **Paste** drop-down arrow.
Then choose **Paste Special** (or press **Ctrl + Alt + V**).
4. In the **Paste Special dialog box**, choose the desired option, for example:
 - **Values** → Pastes only the results, not the formulas.
 - **Formulas** → Pastes only the formulas.
 - **Formats** → Pastes only formatting.
 - **Comments and Notes** → Pastes only comments.
 - **Validation** → Pastes only data validation rules.
5. Click **OK**.



⚙️ **Shortcut Key:** Use **Alt + E + S** for quick keyboard access to Paste Special.

▶ **See how it works:** Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

ZOOM IN / ZOOM OUT

Method 1: Using the Zoom Slider (Quickest)

1. Look at the **bottom right corner** of the Excel window.
2. Find the **Zoom Slider** (a slider with a **-** and **+**).
3. **Drag the slider to the left** to zoom out (smaller view of the worksheet).

Method 2: Using the View Tab

1. Go to the **View** tab on the Ribbon.
2. Click **Zoom** → **Custom**.
3. Enter a smaller percentage (e.g., 50% or 75%) to zoom out.

Method 3: Using Keyboard + Mouse

1. Hold the **Ctrl** key.
2. Scroll the **mouse wheel down** to zoom out.

Tip:

- Zooming out **does not change the size of the cells** when printing; it only changes your **on-screen view**.

INSERT OR DELETE ROWS, COLUMNS, OR CELLS**1. To Insert****a. Insert a Row**

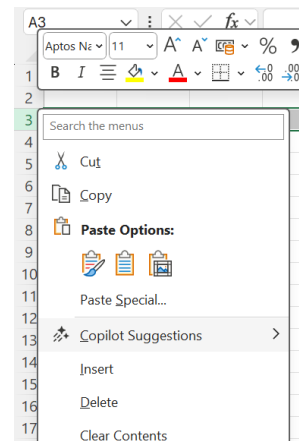
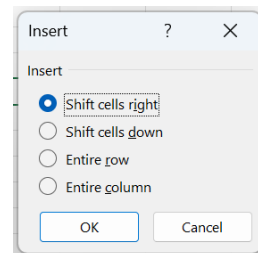
1. Select the row **below** where you want the new row to appear.
2. Right-click the row number → choose **Insert**.
→ A new row appears **above** the selected one.

b. Insert a Column

1. Select the column **to the right** of where you want the new column.
2. Right-click the column letter → choose **Insert**.
→ A new column appears **to the left** of the selected one.

c. Insert a Single Cell

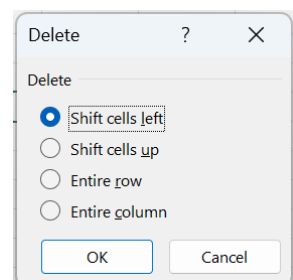
1. Select the cell where you want the new cell.
2. Right-click → choose **Insert**.
3. In the dialog box, select either
 - **Shift cells right**, or
 - **Shift cells down** → then click **OK**.

**2. To Delete****a. Delete a Row or Column**

- Select the row number or column letter.
- Right-click → choose **Delete**.

b. Delete a Single Cell

1. Select the cell.
2. Right-click → choose **Delete**.
3. Choose whether to **shift cells left** or **shift cells up** → click **OK**.



Tip: Always check your data before deleting rows or cells to avoid losing important information.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

RESIZE ROWS/COLUMNS TO FIT CONTENTS**1. Using the Mouse (Manual Resize)**

- Move your cursor to the **border** of the row number (for rows) or column letter (for columns). When the cursor changes to a **double-headed arrow**, **click and drag** to adjust the size.

2. Using AutoFit (Automatic Resize)

a. For Columns:

1. Select the column(s) you want to resize.
2. Go to the **Home** tab → **Cells group** → **Format** → **AutoFit Column Width**. Excel will automatically adjust the column width to fit the longest entry.

b. For Rows:

1. Select the row(s) you want to resize.
2. Go to **Home** → **Format** → **AutoFit Row Height**. Excel will adjust the row height to fit the tallest cell content.

3. Using Double-Click (Quickest Method)

- **Columns:** Move the cursor to the **right border of the column header** → **double-click** → column auto-resizes.
- **Rows:** Move the cursor to the **bottom border of the row header** → **double-click** → row auto-resizes.



Tip:

- AutoFit works best when there's **text wrapping** or **varying content sizes**.
- You can select **multiple rows or columns** and apply AutoFit to all at once.

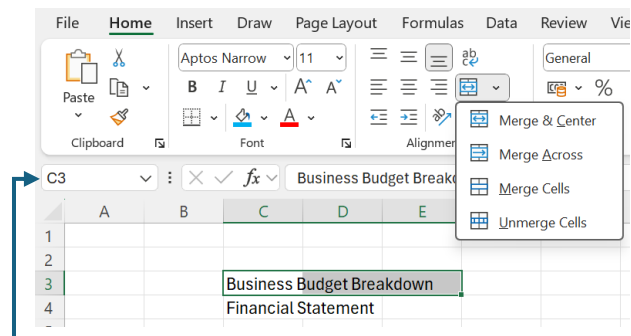


See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

MERGE CELLS

You can **merge cells** to combine two or more cells into one larger cell, often used for **titles or headers** in a worksheet.

1. Select the cells you want to merge.
2. Go to the **Home** tab on the Ribbon.
3. In the **Alignment group**, click the **Merge & Center** drop-down arrow.
4. Choose one of the following options:
 - **Merge & Center** → merges the cells and centers the text.
 - **Merge Across** → merges each row of selected cells separately.
 - **Merge Cells** → merges without centering the text.
 - **Unmerge Cells** → separates merged cells back into individual cells.



Tip:

- When you write a long text in a cell, the content will remain in the selected cell only. All other cells will stay empty.
- When you merge cells, **only the content of the top-left cell** is kept, even the **cell reference**, all other data in the merged range will be deleted.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

CHAPTER

4

CREATE TABLES

◆ Step-by-Step: How to Create a Table

1. Select Your Data

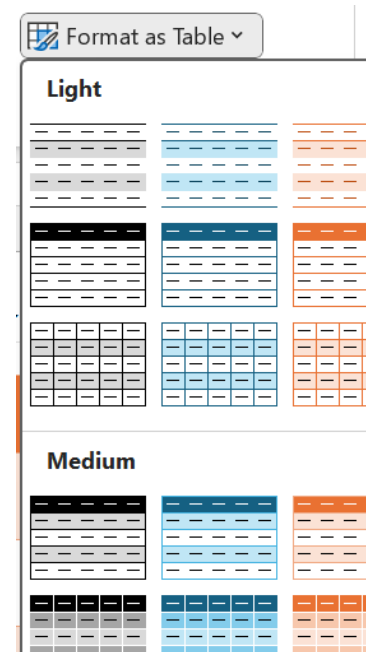
- Highlight the cells that contain your data, including headers.
Example:

2. Insert Table

- Go to the **Home** tab → **Format as Table** → choose a style
OR
- Go to the **Insert** tab → click **Table**

3. Confirm the Table Range

- Excel will ask: “Where is the data for your table?”
- Make sure the range is correct.
- Check “**My table has headers**” if your first row contains column names.
- Click **OK**



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

APPLYING FILTER

Step-by-Step: How to Apply a Filter

1. Select Your Data

- Highlight your data range **including headers**.

2. Apply Filter

Option 1:

- Go to the **Home** tab → **Sort & Filter** → click **Filter**

Option 2:

- Go to the **Data** tab → click **Filter**
- Small dropdown arrows appear in each **header cell**.

3. Use the Filter

- Click the **dropdown arrow** in the column you want to filter.
- Choose the criteria.



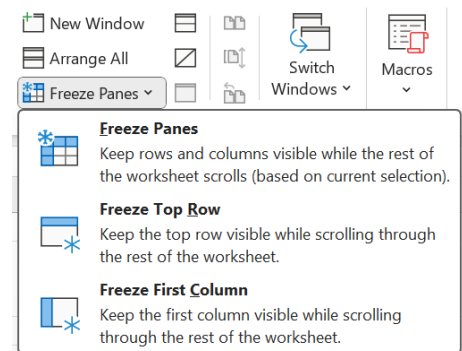
Student ID	Name
101	Matt
102	Sara



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

FREEZE PANES

1. Open your worksheet that has several rows or columns of data.
2. Go to the **View** tab on the Ribbon.
3. In the Window group, click **Freeze Panes**.
4. Choose one of the following options:
 - Freeze Panes: Keeps rows above and columns to the left of your selected cell visible while you scroll.
 - Freeze Top Row: Keeps only the first row visible as you scroll down.
 - Freeze First Column: Keeps only the first column visible as you scroll to the right.
5. To remove the frozen area, go to View → Freeze Panes → Unfreeze Panes.



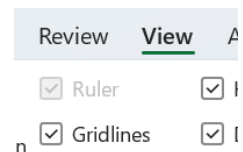
Tip:

- This is very useful for **large class lists** where you need to see both the student names and subjects while scrolling.

See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

HIDING GRIDLINES

1. Go to the **View** tab on the Ribbon.
2. In the **Show** group, **uncheck the box** next to **Gridlines**. The gridlines will disappear from the worksheet.
3. To **show them again**, simply **check the box** next to **Gridlines**.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

NAME A SPECIFIC AREA OF CELLS AND CALL IT IN EXCEL

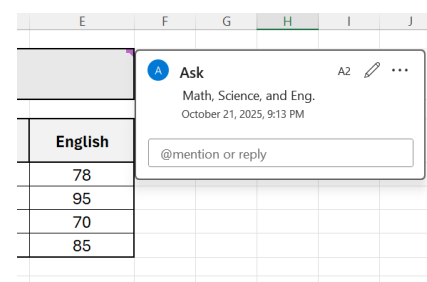
1. **Select** the cell or range of cells you want to name.
2. Go to the **Formulas** tab → **Defined Names** group → **Define Name**.
3. In the dialog box, type a **name** for the range (no spaces allowed).
4. Click **OK**.

Note: Later in this book, you can use the names of these areas in formulas.

See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

INSERT A COMMENT IN A CELL

1. **Select the cell** where you want to add a comment.
2. Go to the **Review** tab → **Comments** group → **New Comment**.
3. A comment box will appear — **type your note**.
4. Press **Enter** or click outside the box to save the comment.

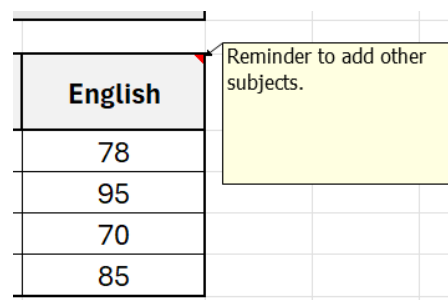


See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

ADDING A SMALL REMINDER, USING A NOTE

Steps to Insert a Note

1. **Right-click the cell** where you want to add a note.
2. Select **New Note** from the context menu.
3. A small **note box** will appear — type your text.
4. Click outside the box to save the note.



Tips for Using Notes

- A **red triangle** appears in the top-right corner of the cell to indicate a note.
- Hover over the cell to **view the note**.
- Right-click the cell to **edit, delete, or format** the note.



Extra:

- In **Excel 365**, **Notes** are different from **Comments**:
 - **Notes**: Simple reminders or explanations.
 - **Comments**: Threaded discussions for collaboration with others.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

FIND AND REPLACE

1. Open Find and Replace

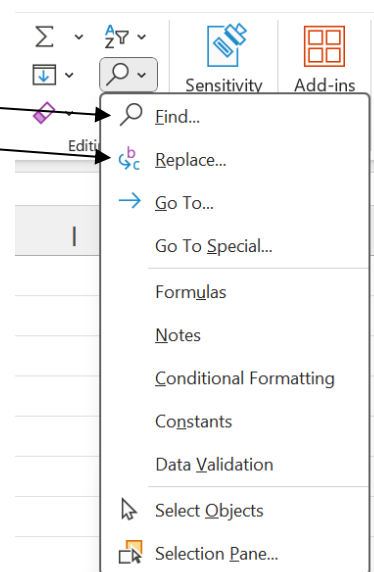
- Press **Ctrl + F** → opens **Find**.
- Press **Ctrl + H** → opens **Replace**.

2. Find

1. In the **Find what** box, type the text or number you want to locate.
2. Click **Find Next** to go to the next occurrence.
3. Click **Find All** to see a list of all occurrences in the worksheet.

3. Replace

1. In the **Replace with** box, type the text or number you want to use instead.
2. Click **Replace** to change the **current instance**.
3. Click **Replace All** to change **all occurrences** at once.



Tips:

- You can use options like **Match Case** or **Match Entire Cell Contents** for more precise searches.
- Always double-check before using **Replace All**, as it can change multiple cells at once.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

CHAPTER 5

CHECK SPELLING

1. Go to the **Review tab** on the Ribbon.
2. Click **Spelling** (or press **F7**).
3. Excel will start checking for spelling errors in your worksheet.
4. For each potential error, Excel gives options to:
 - **Change** → correct the word.
 - **Ignore Once** → skip this word.
 - **Add to Dictionary** → treat this word as correct in future.
5. When finished, Excel will show a message: **“Spell check complete.”**



Tips:

- Spell check works **only on text**, not numbers or formulas.
- It can be used for **cell content, comments, and headers**.
- For multiple sheets, check each sheet individually.



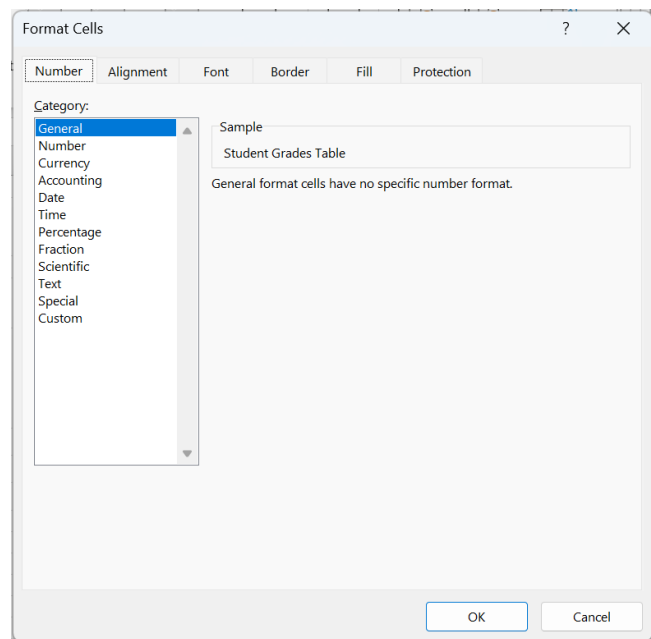
See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

FORMAT CELLS & SHEET PROTECTION

The Format Cells feature allows you to change the appearance and behavior of the data in a cell or range of cells. You can format numbers, text, alignment, borders, fill colors, and more to make your worksheet clear and professional.

Steps to Format Cells

1. Select the cell(s) you want to format.
2. **Right-click** the selection → choose **Format Cells...**
(Or go to **Home tab** → **Cells group** → **Format** → **Format Cells**)
3. In the Format Cells dialog box, you will see several tabs:
 - **Number:** Change the data type (e.g., General, Number, Currency, Date, Percentage).
 - **Alignment:** Adjust text alignment, orientation, and text control (wrap text, shrink to fit).
 - **Font:** Change font type, style, size, color, and effects.
 - **Border:** Add or modify cell borders.
 - **Fill:** Apply cell background color or pattern.
 - **Protection:** Lock or hide cells for worksheet protection.
4. Click **OK** to apply the changes.



💡 Tips:

- Formatting cells helps make data easier to read.
- Use Number formatting for financial, date, or percentage values to avoid mistakes in calculations.
- Borders and fill colors make tables look organized and professional.

🔒 Sheet Protection

Sheet Protection allows you to restrict changes to a worksheet while still letting users view the data. It helps prevent accidental edits or deletions in important worksheets.

Steps to Protect a Sheet

1. Go to the **Review** tab on the Ribbon.
2. Click **Protect Sheet**.
3. In the dialog box:
 - Enter a **password** (optional), users need this to unprotect the sheet.
 - Check or uncheck the actions you want to allow (e.g., Select locked cells, Format cells, Insert rows).
4. Click **OK**.
5. If you entered a password, confirm it and click **OK** again.

💡 Tips:

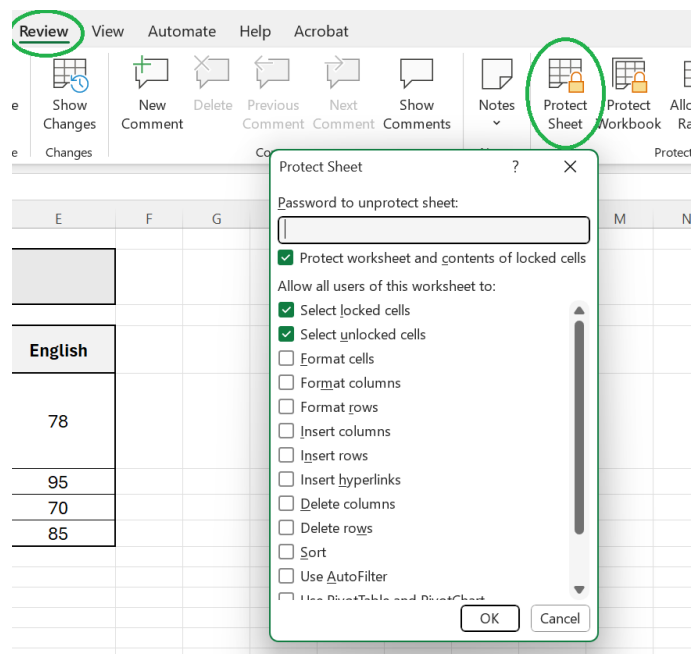
- Once a sheet is protected using **Format Cells** → Protection, **locked cells cannot be edited**, but **unlocked cells remain editable**.
- To allow certain cells to be editable before protecting the sheet:
 1. Select the cells → Right-click → Format Cells → Protection tab → Uncheck **Locked**.
 2. Then apply **Protect Sheet**.
- To remove protection: **Review** → **Unprotect Sheet** → enter password (if any).

💡 Use Cases:

- Protect important **financial reports, student grades, or dashboards**.
- Prevent accidental deletion of **formulas or key data**.



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!



CONDITIONAL FORMATTING

⚙️ How to Apply Conditional Formatting

1. **Select the cells** you want to format.
2. Go to the **Home** tab → **Conditional Formatting** (in the *Styles* group).
3. Choose one of these options:
 - **Highlight Cells Rules** → e.g. *Greater Than, Less Than, Between, Equal To*
 - **Top/Bottom Rules** → e.g. *Top 10 Items, Bottom 10%*
 - **Data Bars** → adds horizontal bars to show relative size of values
 - **Color Scales** → shades colors according to cell values
 - **Icon Sets** → shows icons (like arrows or traffic lights) to represent value levels
4. Enter the condition and formatting style you want.
5. Click **OK** — Excel will automatically apply the format based on your rule.

Total Marks	Final Decision
253	Pass
133	Fail
225	Pass
108	Fail
133	Fail
274	Pass
72	Fail

✏️ To Edit or Remove a Rule

- Go to **Home** → **Conditional Formatting** → **Manage Rules**
- You can:
 - **Edit Rule** → change condition or format
 - **Delete Rule** → remove formatting



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

SORTING DATA

What is Sorting in Excel?

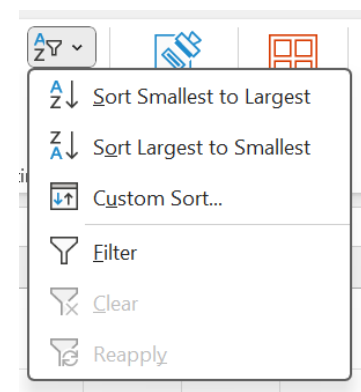
Sorting means arranging your data in a specific order, for example:

- **A to Z** (Alphabetical)
- **Z to A** (Reverse alphabetical)
- **Smallest to Largest**
- **Largest to Smallest**

It helps you organize and analyze data easily.

How to Sort a Single Column

1. Select any cell in the column you want to sort.
2. Go to the **Home** tab.
3. In the **Editing** group, click **Sort & Filter**.
4. Choose:
 - **Sort A to Z** (Ascending)
 - **Sort Z to A** (Descending)



How to Sort a Table or Multiple Columns

1. Select the entire table (or click inside the table if you formatted it as a table).
2. Go to the **Data** tab.
3. Click **Sort** (the big Sort button).
4. In the Sort dialog:
 - Choose the **column** you want to sort by.
 - Choose **Sort On** (usually "Values").
 - Choose **Order** (A to Z, Z to A, etc.).
5. Click **OK**.

Important Tip (Very Important!)

Always **select the full table** or click inside the table before sorting.

If you select only one column, the data may become **mismatched**, which can cause serious errors.

A useful tip to avoid this is to apply alternating colors to row groups. For example, make the first four rows yellow, the next four rows a different color, and so on. This makes it easy to spot if any rows become mixed or misaligned after sorting. See the example below where the data has become **mismatched**.

Name	Jan	Feb	Mar	Total Sales/Person
Omar	15500	12400	13500	10500
Chris	10700	10400	5700	10500
Will	5500	10200	3800	10500
John	3850	9900	6400	10500
Sara	11500	9600	8540	10500
Matt	10900	9100	8300	10500

CHAPTER 6

CHARTS

Any figures in Excel can be converted into a chart, which can quickly help analyse the situation without needing to read all the data.

How to Create a Chart

1. Select your data

Highlight the cells that contain the values you want to turn into a chart.

2. Go to the Insert tab

On the ribbon at the top of Excel, click **Insert**.

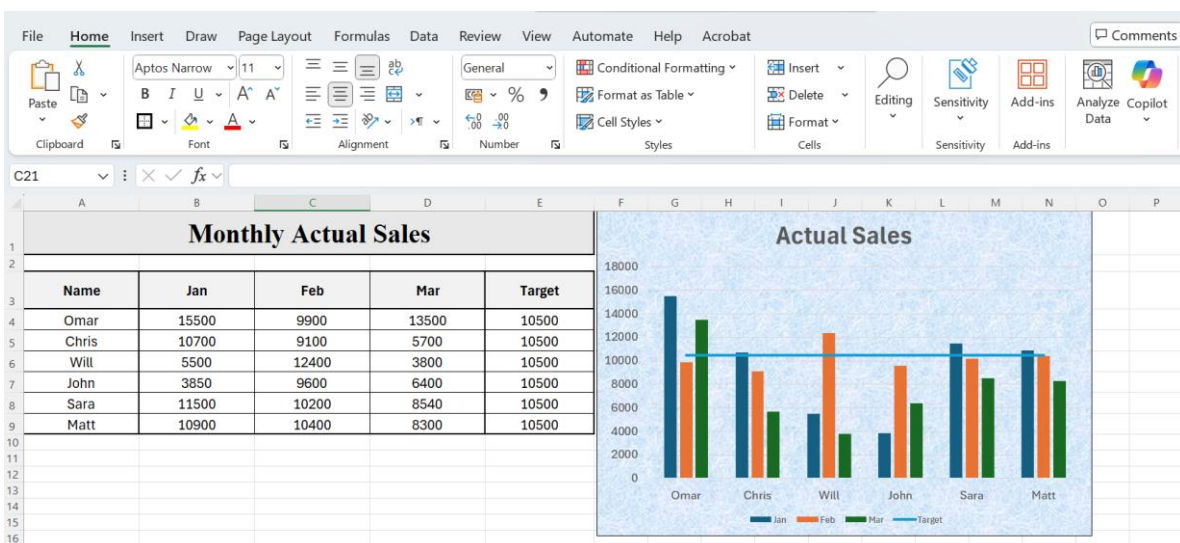
3. Choose a chart type

Under the **Charts** group, select the chart style you prefer, such as:

- **Column Chart** (for comparisons)
- **Line Chart** (for trends over time)
- **Pie Chart** (for percentage or proportion)
- **Bar Chart, Area Chart**, etc.

4. Customize the chart (optional)

- Add a **chart title**
- Adjust **labels, colors**, and **format axes** if needed



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

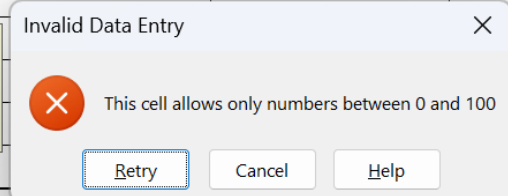
VALIDATION

Used to control what users can enter into a cell.

1. **Select cells** where you want to restrict input.
2. Go to **Data → Data Validation**.
3. In **Settings**, choose the type of data (e.g., whole number, date, list) and set limits or source values.
4. (Optional) Add an **Input Message** to guide users.
5. (Optional) Add an **Error Alert** to show a warning if invalid data is entered.
6. Click **OK** and test your rules.

Student ID	Name	Math	Science	English	Total
101	Matt	120			
102	Sara				
103	Omar				
104	Lina				
108	Emma				

Guidance
Enter marks between 0 and 100



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

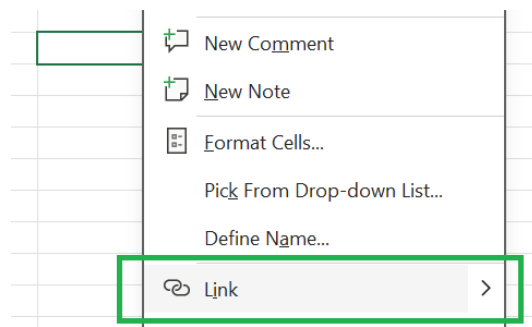
HYPERLINK

A **hyperlink in Excel** is a clickable link that takes you to another location—this can be:

- Another **cell or sheet** in the same workbook
- A **website or URL**
- An **email address**
- A **file** on your computer

How to add a hyperlink in Excel:

1. **Select the cell** where you want the hyperlink.
2. **Right-click** and choose **Link** (or press Ctrl + K).
3. In the dialog box, choose what you want to link to:
 - **Existing File or Web Page** → enter the URL or browse the file.
 - **Place in This Document** → choose a cell or sheet.
 - **Create New Document** → set up a new file.
 - **Email Address** → type the email address.
4. Click **OK**.



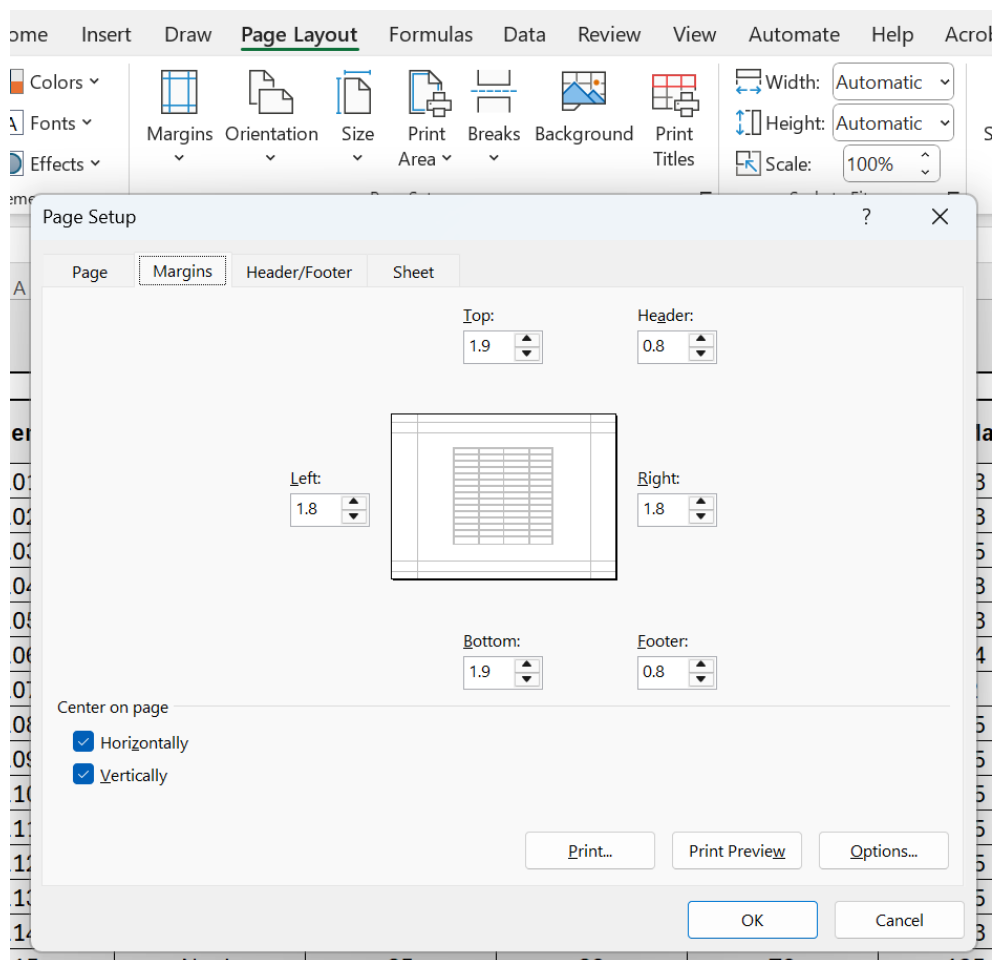
PAGE SETUP

Option 1: Ribbon

1. Go to the **Page Layout** tab.
2. You'll see groups like:
 - **Margins** → adjust top, bottom, left, right margins
 - **Orientation** → Portrait or Landscape
 - **Size** → select paper size (A4, Letter, etc.)
 - **Print Area** → select specific cells to print
 - **Breaks** → insert page breaks
 - **Background** → add a background image (won't print by default)
 - **Print Titles** → repeat rows/columns on each printed page

Option 2: Page Setup Dialog

1. Click the small **arrow icon** in the bottom-right corner of the **Page Layout** group (next to "Margins" or "Page Setup").
2. This opens the **Page Setup dialog box** with four tabs:
 - **Page** → orientation, paper size, scaling
 - **Margins** → adjust margins and center on page
 - **Header/Footer** → add custom header/footer text or images
 - **Sheet** → select print options (gridlines, row/column headings, print area)



◆ Key Page Setup Options

Option	Purpose
Orientation	Portrait (vertical) or Landscape (horizontal)
Size	Choose paper size (A4, Letter, etc.)
Margins	Adjust top, bottom, left, right margins
Print Area	Print only selected cells
Print Titles	Repeat headers on every page
Scaling	Fit all data to 1 page wide/tall
Headers/Footers	Add text, page numbers, date, or images
Gridlines & Headings	Decide whether to print them

See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

PRINT

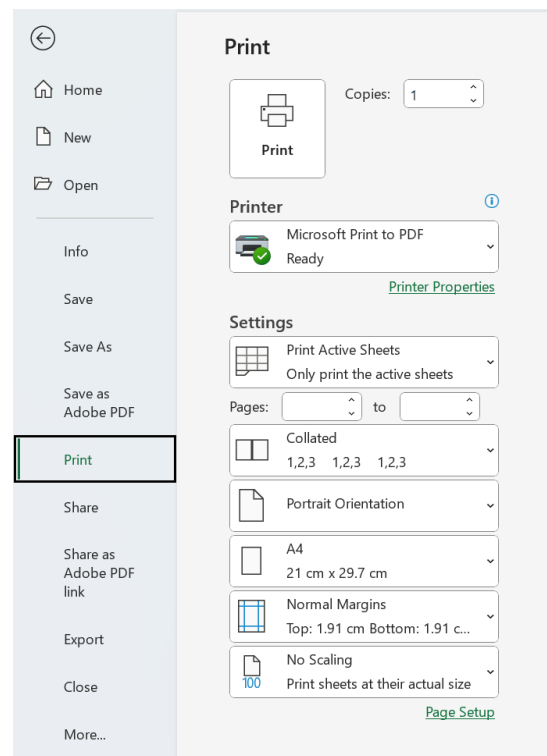
Printing Excel data

If your goal is to **print the Excel sheet**:

1. **Select the range** you want to print.
2. Go to **File → Print**.
3. Choose **Print Selection** or **Print Entire Sheet**.
4. Adjust settings like **orientation, margins, and scaling**.
5. Click **Print**.

✓ Shortcut recap

- **Ctrl + P** → Print
- **Alt + P, S** → Print selection (depending on Excel version)



CHAPTER

7

Functions

In Excel, a function is a predefined formula that performs a specific calculation using the values (called arguments) you provide.

Since this book avoids unnecessary explanation and focuses on hands-on practice, **click on the function name** next to the YouTube icon below to see how each function works and to better understand its use.

Function	What It Does	Syntax
<u>SUM</u> This video includes the next three functions as well	Adds numbers in a range	=SUM(number1, [number2], ...)
<u>SUBTRACTION</u>	Subtracts numbers	=number1-number2
<u>PRODUCT</u>	Multiplies numbers	=PRODUCT(number1, [number2], ...)
<u>DIVISION</u>	Divides numbers	=number1/number2
<u>SQRT</u>	Returns the square root $\sqrt{x}$	=SQRT(number)
<u>POWER</u>	Raises a number to a power x^2	=POWER(number, POWER)
<u>AVERAGE</u>	Calculates the average	=AVERAGE(number1, [number2], ...)
<u>MAX</u>	Returns the largest value in a set of values.	MAX(number1, [number2], ...)
<u>MIN</u>	Returns the smallest number in a set of values.	MIN(number1, [number2], ...)
<u>IF</u>	Logical test: returns value if TRUE or FALSE	=IF(logical_test, value_if_true, value_if_false)
<u>VLOOKUP</u>	Vertical lookup in table	=VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])
<u>XLOOKUP</u>	Modern lookup function (vertical/horizontal)	=XLOOKUP(lookup_value, lookup_array, return_array,

Function	What It Does	Syntax
		[if_not_found], [match_mode], [search_mode])
▶ <u>CONCATENATE</u> / <u>CONCAT</u>	Joins text	=CONCATENATE(text1,text2,...) =CONCAT(text1,text2,...)
▶ <u>LEN</u>	Returns length of text	=LEN(TEXT)
▶ <u>PROPER</u> / <u>UPPER</u> / <u>LOWER</u>	Capitalizes first letter of each word. Converts text to uppercase.	=PROPER(TEXT) =UPPER(TEXT) =LOWER(TEXT)
▶ <u>NOW</u> / <u>TODAY</u>	Returns current date & time	=NOW() =TODAY()
▶ <u>PMT</u>	Calculates loan payment	=PMT(rate,nper,pv,[fv],[type])
▶ <u>PV</u>	PV (Present Value) tells you how much future money is worth today.	PV(rate, nper, pmt, [fv], [type])
▶ <u>FV</u>	Future value of an investment using the terms in A2:A5.	FV(rate, nper, pmt, [pv], [type]) Pmt: Use 0 if there are no regular payments
▶ <u>COUNT</u>	Counts numbers in range	=COUNT(value1, [value2], ...)
▶ <u>COUNTA</u>	Counts non-empty cells	=COUNTA(value1, ...)
▶ <u>COUNTIF</u>	Counts cells meeting a condition	=COUNTIF(range, criteria)

MACRO

What is a Macro in Excel?

A **Macro** in Excel is a **set of recorded steps or instructions** that Excel can **repeat automatically**. It is used to **save time** when you need to do the **same task many times**, such as:

- Formatting tables
- Generating reports
- Copying and organizing data
- Running calculations

Example:

If you always:

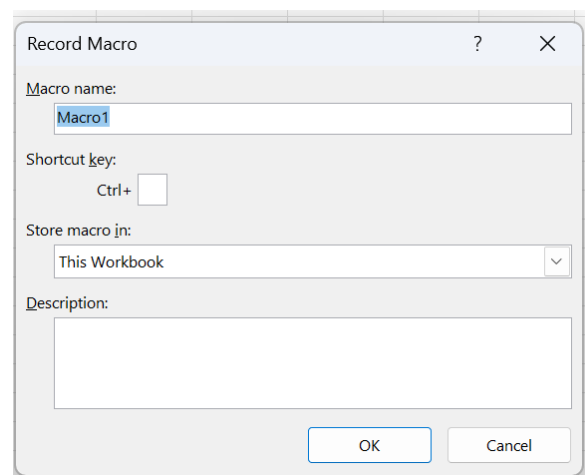
1. Bold the header
2. Change the font size
3. Add a border
4. Color the first row

You can **record these steps once** → then click a **button** to repeat them anytime.

Where to Find Macros

1. Go to **Developer** tab
 - If it's not visible:
 - **File** → **Options** → **Customize Ribbon** → Check **“Developer”** → **OK**
2. Click **Record Macro**
3. **Name** your Macro. You may choose to set a **shortcut** key to run it later on.
4. Perform your actions
5. Click **Stop Recording**

Now your macro is saved.



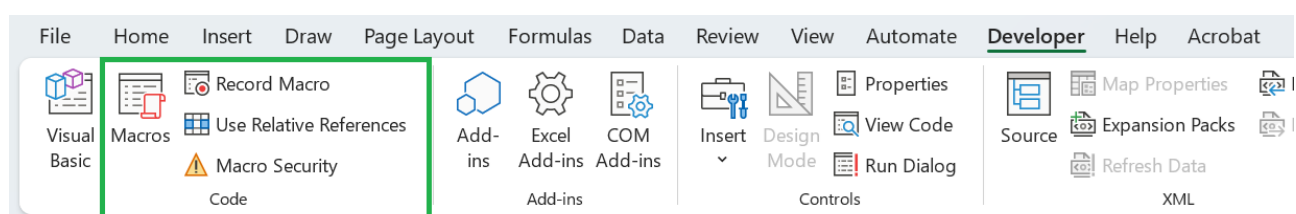
To Run a Macro

- Developer → **Macros** → Select macro name → **Run**
- OR
- Assign it to a **button** in the sheet.

💡 Important Reminder

If you save a file that contains macros, use **.xlsm** format (e.g., Report.xlsm)

Otherwise, the macro will be removed.



If the macro cannot be run, please check and adjust the macro security settings in Excel."

You can also give a step-by-step version for clarity:

1. Go to **File** → **Options** → **Trust Center** → **Trust Center Settings**
2. Select **Macro Settings**
3. Choose **Enable all macros** (or **Disable all macros with notification** for safety)
4. Click **OK**

Tip: Only enable macros from trusted sources to avoid security risks.

See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

PIVOT TABLE

A Pivot Table is a powerful Excel tool that helps you **summarise, analyse, and reorganise large amounts of data** quickly without changing the original data.

	A	B	C	D
1	Country	(All)		
2				
3	Row Labels	Sum of Units Sold	Sum of Unit Price Incl. Tax 2.5% (USD)	Sum of Total (USD)
4	ASUS Zenfone 12 Ultra	15	871.25	13068.75
5	Google Pixel 9 Pro	70	1842.95	64503.25
6	Huawei Mate 80	28	1076.25	30135
7	Huawei Pura 80	60	973.75	58425
8	iPhone 16	85	1637.95	69612.875
9	iPhone 17	115	1947.5	111719.875
10	OnePlus 13	55	1637.95	45043.625
11	Samsung Galaxy A26 5G	65	358.75	23318.75
12	Samsung Galaxy S25	83	2047.95	84989.925
13	Samsung Galaxy S25 Ultra	35	1331.475	46601.625
14	Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 7	42	2457.95	51616.95
15	Xiaomi 15 Ultra	200	2764.425	184295
16	Grand Total	853	18948.15	783330.625
17				
18				
19				
20				
21				
22				
23				
24				

Steps to Create and Use a Pivot Table in Excel

1. **Prepare your data**
 - Make sure your data is organised in columns with clear headers.
 - Each row should represent a single record.
 - Avoid blank rows or blank columns.
2. **Select the data**
 - Click anywhere inside your dataset so Excel recognises the full range automatically.
3. **Insert a Pivot Table**
 - Go to the *Insert* tab.
 - Choose *PivotTable*.
 - Confirm the data source and choose where you want the Pivot Table to be placed.
 - Click *OK*.
4. **Understand the Pivot Table fields**
 - You will see a list of field names and four areas: **Filters, Rows, Columns, and Values**.

5. Build the Pivot Table

- Drag a category field into **Rows** to group data vertically.
- Drag another category field into **Columns** to compare data horizontally.
- Drag numerical fields into **Values** to calculate totals, counts, or averages.
- Use **Filters** to show specific parts of the data.

6. Change calculation types

- Adjust value settings to switch between Sum, Count, Average, or other calculations.
- Apply number formatting to make results easier to read.

7. Refresh the Pivot Table

- When the source data changes, refresh the Pivot Table to update the results.
-

 Why Pivot Tables Are Useful

- Quickly summarise large datasets
- Identify trends and patterns
- Compare performance across categories
- Create reports without complex formulas



See how it works: Watch the short video for a step-by-step visual guide and more!

*** This brings us to the end of this book ***



THANK YOU
For Your Engagement and For Reading This Book



Thank you for reading! We hope this e-book has provided valuable insights and practical guidance on Excel skills. Remember the key points discussed and consider applying them to achieve the results you're aiming for.

Next Steps

If you enjoyed this e-book, here are the best ways to stay connected and continue learning: visit our YouTube channel (scan the above QR code), follow us on social media, and subscribe to receive more valuable skills and insights.

About the Author

The author of this book has developed the above YouTube channel to focus on end-users who want to enhance and develop their Microsoft Excel skills. The channel is designed to help viewers better understand the program and upskill their knowledge through hands-on practice

Contact / Permissions

For questions, feedback, or permission to use content from this book, please contact the author at ask4assist@gmail.com

Thank You

We sincerely appreciate your time and interest in this book.
We hope it inspires you to take action and achieve your goals!
